



DUKE FUQUA

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT DUKE FUQUA

In its relatively short history, The Fuqua School of Business at Duke University has established itself as one of the leading MBA programs in the world. Based in Durham, North Carolina, Duke is part of the world-renowned Research Triangle Park (RTP), one of the oldest and largest science parks in the US with over 200 companies ranging from startups to multinationals. In fact, the Triangle area has recently received national recognition as one of the best places for business and careers.

Fuqua and Duke see themselves as a vital part of this growth. They are looking for individuals who want to do well in business, but also want to make a positive impact on their community and the world. (Prominent alumni include Apple CEO Tim Cook and philanthropist Melinda Gates.) The Fuqua culture is incredibly collaborative and close-knit - Team Fuqua isn't just a saying, but a commitment that the students, faculty, and staff make to one another (which extends to partners of students). Fuqua may have a reputation for marketing & general management, but consulting has quickly become a significant area of focus; six of its top 10 employers were consulting firms last year.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Health Sector Management, Marketing, Technology, Social
Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurship & Innovation

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
BusinessWeek	6	16	20	20	*	*	13
Financial Times	24	19	19	16	9	19	11
US News	12	11	10	12	12	12	11
Poets and Quants	12	14	14	14	14	12	11

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants	3,762	Avg Work Experience	6
MBA Class Size	399	Avg GMAT	718
Total Tuition	US\$150,000	% International	52%
		% Women	48%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2021)

Finance	36%
Consulting	23%
Technology	16%
Health	11%
Starting Own Business	1%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Accenture, Bain, BCG, Deloitte, EY Parthenon, McKinsey, PwC, ZS Associates, Amazon, Apple, Cisco, Dell, Google, Microsoft, Bank of America, Barclays, Citi, Morgan Stanley, Wells Fargo, DaVita, Johnson & Johnson, The Kraft-Heinz Co.

AVERAGE BASE SALARY:	US\$160,055
SALARY INCREASE	130%
EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS:	98%



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR DUKE FUQUA APPLICATION

BY CATHERINE FINCH TUTTLE

Catherine brings deep MBA experience as a former Associate Director at Duke University's Fuqua School of Business. For five years she worked in the Career Management Center creating, implementing, and evaluating programs and coaching MBA's to achieve their career goals. She also served as the liaison to Admissions having worked with them earlier in her career as a Marketing Manager.



Applicants who devote the necessary time to networking with students and alumni will start to understand what Team Fuqua means on a deeper level.

1

BE CLEAR ABOUT YOUR CAREER GOALS & WHY FUQUA

At Fuqua, Admissions and the Career Management Center (CMC) are well connected. Career Center staff educate the team on what to look for in resumes and the key skills/experience required for certain career paths. If questions arise about a candidate, their experience, and how realistic their goals are, they will bring in the Associate Dean of the CMC to get her feedback. That said, you need to be quite clear about your development so far, the specific experience/skills needed from the Duke MBA, and how it all translates short- and long-term.

GET PERSONAL

2

The prompt for the 25 Random Things essay clearly states that Admissions wants to get to know you beyond the professional and academic achievements listed on your resume. This is your opportunity to showcase a different side of yourself that may not come through in traditional MBA applications. It's also the opportunity to connect on a personal level. It is what draws the committee in and, if done right, leads them to advocate for you throughout the process. Think about your values, your hobbies, your interests and important life experiences. These can and should be a mix of poignant, humorous, playful, deep, sad and everything in between. Some may be a paragraph whereas others may be a simple sentence. Also keep in mind that they should resonate with the core values of the Fuqua community – collaboration, diversity, honesty, respect and giving back to a cause greater than yourself.

3

KNOW WHAT TEAM FUQUA MEANS TO YOU

On the surface, Team Fuqua can seem like a tagline or gimmicky slogan, but that's far from the truth. Typically, applicants who devote the necessary time to networking with students and alumni will start to understand what this means on a deeper level. They will hear stories about how students who are competing for the same internship help each other prepare for their interviews, how willing current students are to connect across programs, how alumni continue to engage with the school long after graduation, and how faculty and staff host international students over holiday breaks when they are unable to return to their home country. The sum of the Fuqua community is truly greater than the individual parts and the stories are endless. You need to share your experience and understanding of this deeply relational value throughout your application. 'Tell me what Team Fuqua means to you' is also a favored question among interviewers – both current students

ENVISION YOURSELF ON CAMPUS

4

The second essay asks you how you see yourself contributing to the community outside the classroom. *Outside the classroom* is key. All too often applicants ignore that part of the prompt and wax poetic about how their experience will add value in class discussions. You must go deeper. Fuqua boasts 60+ student clubs, each of which was started and run by students. These clubs and other experiential opportunities allow you to take initiative and flex the leadership muscle they are building in the program. Think about the groups you will be a part of – professional clubs and those that are more light hearted like the Outdoors Club and Wine Club. Then, reflect on your past experience and how it will contribute to Fuqua's mission/goals. If you talk to club members, you'll be even better equipped to articulate how you can add value in vivid detail.

5

HIGHLIGHT CULTURAL COMPETENCY

Fuqua has always put an emphasis on diversity and takes pride in the fact that its student body is consistently around 40% international. In fact, the main hallway is lined with flags representing the many countries students come from. Teams are purposefully made of individuals from different genders, ethnicities, and functional and industry backgrounds. It's important that your savvy self- and cultural awareness shines throughout your application. Look for ways to stress your experience working with globally diverse teams and why a global perspective is important to you personally and professionally.

Read insider essay strategies for Duke Fuqua [here](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	INTERVIEW DECISION	FINAL DECISION
Early Action	07 Sept 2023	21 Sept 2023	19 Oct 2023
Round 1	28 Sept 2023	26 Oct 2023	08 Dec 2023
Round 2	09 Jan 2024	02 Feb 2024	12 March 2024
Round 3	22 February 2024	13 March 2024	05 April 2024
Round 4	04 April 2024	19 April 2024	10 May 2024



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, schedule yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

